BEST BRAIN EXAMINATIONS KONSORTIUM
SPECIAL PRIVATE MOCK EXAMINATIONS FOR BECE CANDIDATES – SEPTEMBER 2026
MARKING SCHEME – ENGLISH LANGUAGE

PAPER 2 [60 MARKS]

PART A - WRITING [30 MARKS]

GENERAL PREAMBLE

1. There are three parts- A, B and C. Candidates are expected to answer three questions in all, ONE question from PART A and Questions 4 & 5. If a candidate attempts more than one question from PART A, mark BOTH and choose the better of the two.
2. The required length of each composition is **250 words.**
3. **Mark Allocation:** Each composition is to be marked out of a total of 30 marks distributed as follows:

   (a) CONTENT **10 MARKS**

   Ensure that the candidate presents a set of relevant points or details that are central to the theme or essay topic.

   (b) ORGANIZATION **5 MARKS**

   The writing must be judged as whatever it is intended to be: an article, a speech, a letter, a debate, etc. Look for suitable layout, suitable opening, adequate development, good paragraph, balance, coherence and a suitable conclusion.

   (c) EXPRESSION **10 MARKS**

   Look out for correct usage of language, variation in sentence structure and type, judicious use of figurative language, and skillful use of punctuation. In arriving at the mark for expression, do not be unduly influenced by mechanical errors.

   (d) MECHANICAL ACCURACY **5 MARKS**

   Look out for undeniable errors in grammar, punctuation and spelling.
4. If a candidate writes on a topic other than the one set, award zero (0) for Content and mark Expression out of 5. The allocations for organization and Mechanical Accuracy remain unchanged.
5. Each ring should attract a deduction of half a mark (½). Formal features of letters should have two rings only counted against Mechanical Accuracy. Subsequent errors in the formal features should be underlined only.
6. In general, the principle of positive marking should be applied, i.e., give credit for what the candidate has done right and then penalize for errors. These penalties are not, in all cases, numerical deductions but often the result of a lower mark than would have been earned if there were no blemishes.
7. The candidate is expected to know the simple mechanics of the English Language. These include spelling, punctuation, subject-verb concord, noun-pronoun agreement and the use of the capital letters. He or she should also be able to control the use of determiners, quantifiers, prepositions, etc.
8. **Penalize**

   (i) ***Each Grammatical Error*:** These include
   - the omission of an essential sentence element
   - wrong tense;
   - misuse or omission of the article;
   - misuse of modal operators (may/might, etc)
   - confusion or ambiguity in the use of pronouns;
   - misuse of countable and uncountable nouns;
   - wrong prepositions;
   - misuse of relatives/subordinators/ conjunctions;
   - errors in concord;
   - intransitive verbs for transitive and vice versa;
   - active for passive and vice versa;
   - faulty construction.

   (ii) ***The wrong amalgamation or breaking up of words e.g.***

   "inspite" for in spite
   "infront" for in front
   "every where" for everywhere
   "to day" for today
   "every body" for everybody
   "ofcourse" for of course

   "infact" for in fact
   "never the less" for nevertheless
   "how ever" for however
   "more over" for moreover
   "now a days" for nowadays,
   etc.

   (iii) ***Wrong Spelling*** - the wrong spelling of the same word should be penalized only once. American spelling, if consistent, should be accepted.

   (iv) ***Punctuation Error and the Wrong Use of the Capital Letter.***
   - Each full stop, question mark or exclamation mark omitted or wrongly used; the misuse or omission of quotation marks. Both single and double quotation marks are accepted, but consistency is to be demanded.
   - The insertion of a comma between subject and verb, subject and object, verb and complement, in simple structures only, i.e., where phrases or clauses do not intervene.

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- The insertion of comma between adjective and noun, or verb and adverb; the omission of a comma used to separate items in a list of words, phrases or clauses.
- The use of a small letter for pronoun 'I'; use of a small letter at the beginning of a proper noun or sentence.
- Where a proper noun consists of more than one element, each of which is expected to begin with a capital letter eg. Electricity Company of Ghana, there should be only one penalty for the group.
- Initials in abbreviations with or without full stop should be accepted, eg G.C.B or GCB, W.A.E.C or WAEC. First and last letters: both forms should be accepted, eg. Dr and Dr.; Mrs and Mrs.

NB: ***This list is not exhaustive. It is merely to indicate the type of undeniable errors to be penalized.***

9. Each of these errors should be ringed and half a mark (½) deducted up to a total of 5 marks
10. ASSESSMENT GUIDE

	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Average	Below Average	Illiterate
Content	9 - 10	7 - 8	6	5	3 - 4	0 - 2½
Organization	5	4 - 4½	3 - 3½	1½ - 2	1 - 1½	0 - 1
Expression	9 – 10	7 - 8	6	5	3 - 4	0 - 2½

Number of words			Number of Words	Mechanical Accuracy
5 words on a line	=	50 lines	250 words	= 5
6 words on a line	=	42 lines	225 words	= 4½
7 words on a line	=	36 lines	200 words	= 4
8 words on a line	=	31 lines	175 words	= 3½
9 words on a line	=	28 lines	150 words	= 3
10 words on a line	=	25 lines	100 words	= 2
11 words on a line		23 lines	75 words	= 1½
12 words on a line	=	21 lines	50 words	= 1
13 words on a line	=	19 lines	25 words	= ½

QUESTION 1

CONTENT – 10 MARKS -The candidate is expected to write a formal letter to the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources expressing his/her views on the activities of some mining companies and suggesting at least three measures the government can take to stop mining companies from engaging in galamsey. If only one relevant point is given, mark out of 3 marks. If two relevant points are given and explained, mark out of 6 marks. A candidate who gives three or more relevant and well-explained points should score 6 marks or above. Mere listing of points without explanation should not score more than 2 marks.

ORGANISATION – 5 MARKS

This is a formal letter, so the following formal features must be present:

(i) Writer's address and date
(ii) Recipient's address
(iii) Salutation Dear Sir/Madam
(iv) Heading/Title
(v) Body of letter – Introduction, Main Content, Conclusion
(vi) Subscription – Yours faithfully
(vii) Writer's signature and full name

The candidate should show a good introduction and conclusion. Each paragraph should be properly developed and linked. A mere listing of points should not score more than 2 marks.

EXPRESSION – 10 MARKS

The language should be formal. The candidate should avoid slang, contracted forms, colloquialisms and conversational expressions. Diction and register should be appropriate. The candidate should vary sentence patterns and use appropriate punctuation.

MECHANICAL ACCURACY – 5 MARKS

As in the general marking guidelines.

QUESTION 2

CONTENT – 10 MARKS -The candidate is expected to write an informal letter to a friend explaining the dangers of religious extremism and suggesting two ways the government can help prevent such activities. If only one relevant point is given, mark out of 3 marks. If two relevant points are given and explained, mark out of 6 marks. A candidate who gives well-explained points on the dangers and preventive measures should score 6 marks or above. Mere listing of points without explanation should not score more than 2 marks.

ORGANISATION – 5 MARKS

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This is an informal letter, so the following features are mandatory:
a) Address of the writer and Date
b) Salutation - Dear + Recipient's first name
c) Introduction
d) Main content/body
e) Conclusion
f) Subscription - Yours sincerely/Yours ever/Your friend
The letter should have a good introduction and conclusion. A mere listing of points should not score more than 2 marks. If the candidate does not write a letter, mark out of 3. Good paragraphing should be rewarded.

EXPRESSION – 10 MARKS

The language should be informal. The candidate may use appropriate contractions, colloquialisms and conversational expressions. Diction should be appropriate. The candidate is expected to use appropriate register and idioms. The candidate should vary sentence patterns and use punctuation effectively.

MECHANICAL ACCURACY – 5 MARKS

As for Question 1.

QUESTION 3

CONTENT – 10 MARKS- The candidate is expected to write an article for publication in a national newspaper discussing at least three causes of flooding and suggesting three practical ways to reduce the problem. If only one relevant point is given, mark out of 3 marks. If two relevant points are given and explained, mark out of 6 marks. A candidate who explains at least three causes and three practical ways well should score 6 marks or above. Mere listing of points without explanation should not score more than 2 marks.

ORGANISATION – 5 MARKS

This is an article. The candidate should show the following features:
a. Heading/Title (with writer's name under it)
b. Introduction
c. Main content
d. Conclusion
The introduction and conclusion should be suitable. Each paragraph should be well-developed and linked properly. Good paragraphing should be rewarded.

EXPRESSION – 10 MARKS

The language must be formal and suitable for publication in a national newspaper. It should be void of inappropriate slang, contractions and colloquialisms. Candidates should use appropriate register, varied sentence patterns and suitable rhetorical devices to sustain the reader's interest. Masterful use of punctuation should be rewarded.

MECHANICAL ACCURACY – 5 MARKS

As for Question 1.

PART B - READING [20 marks]

PENALTIES FOR QUESTION 4

(a) Deduct half a mark for any grammatical/expression error(s) at each scoring point.
(b) Where a candidate gives two answers to a question and one of them is wrong, award zero. If, however, both answers are correct award full marks.
(c) Where words /expressions are expected to be given to replace words /expressions in the passage, they must fit in perfectly. Otherwise, award zero.
(d) Answers need not be written in sentences, unless otherwise stipulated.
(e) An answer, taken as a whole, must make sense before any part of it may be accepted for scoring.
(f) **Question 4(f)** (*Explanation of expressions)*
  (i) Award zero (0) if any content/ main word in the expression being tested is repeated.
  (ii) Award zero (0) if a candidate uses fixed expressions (idioms, phrasal verbs …..)
(g) **Question 4(h)** (*Summary)*
  (i) Award half the allocated mark if the answer is not written in a complete sentence.
  (ii) Apt lifting **within the stipulated number of words** is allowed.
  (iii) Deduct half a mark (½) if an answer exceeds the required number of words (extraneous material)
  (iv) Deduct half a mark (½) for any grammatical/ expression error in a correct answer.
  (v) Deduct half a mark (½) for any extraneous material in a correct answer

QUESTION 4 [20 MARKS]

(a) More countries had the opportunity to compete against the best. **[2 marks]**
(b) Long journeys / unfamiliar surroundings /Pressure from millions of supporters **@ 1 mark each =** **[2 marks]**

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(c) Fatigue could affect players' performance. [2 marks]

(d) (i) Watching matches / debating teams / celebrating victories. [1 mark]
(ii) They cheered together at viewing centres. [1 mark]

(e) (e) (i) *football's most treasured prize* – World Cup trophy / greatest soccer award [1 mark]
(ii) *footballing elite* – top teams / best teams / leading teams / strongest teams [1 mark]
(iii) *enormous demands* – great challenges / heavy demands / serious challenges / major demands [1 mark]
(iv) *use every opportunity* well – use every chance well / take advantage of every chance [1 mark]

(f) (i) *tournament*: competition / championship / contest / event / games / [½ mark]
(ii) *remarkable* – outstanding / extraordinary / exceptional / impressive / notable / amazing [½ mark]
(iii) *fatigue*- tiredness / exhaustion / weariness / lethargy / drain [½ mark]
(iv) *disappointment*- sadness / letdown / dismay / frustration / heartbreak / chagrin [½ mark]
(v) *underestimating*- underrating / taking for granted / misjudging / undervaluing / discounting [½ mark]
(vi) *gradually* – slowly / progressively / steadily / little by little / step by step / bit by bit [½ mark]
(vii) *predicted*- foreseen / anticipated / expected / foretold / projected / forecasted [½ mark]
(viii) *valuable* -useful / beneficial / important / worthwhile / helpful / precious / advantageous [½ mark]

(g) (i) Preparation is important for success/Proper preparation and teamwork lead to success.
(ii) Teamwork helps people achieve their goals. **Any 2 correct @ 1 mark each =** [2 marks]

(h) The World Cup unites people through shared experiences.
It brings people together to celebrate victories.
It unites people through football and shared celebrations. **Any 1 correct @ 2 marks** [2 marks]

PART C- LITERATURE [10 marks]

PENALTIES FOR QUESTION 5

(a) Deduct half a mark for any grammatical/expression error(s) at each scoring point.
(b) Where a candidate gives two answers to a question and one of them is wrong, award zero (o). If, however, both answers are correct award full marks.
(c) An answer, taken as a whole, must make sense before any part of it may be accepted for scoring.
(d) Award zero if a candidate spells a name, a literary device, etc. wrongly

Question

(a) Bediako could not accept that Kissiwaa was better than him / Bediako was angry about losing to Kissiwaa / Bediako challenged Kissiwaa's success. [1 mark]
(b) He was shocked / He was surprised / He was concerned. [1 mark]
(c) Mrs Mann. [½ mark]
(d) Naming the orphan babies in alphabetical order / Using the alphabet to name the babies [1 mark]
(e) She is committed to excellence / She is committed to the project / She is not ready to give up. [1 mark]
(f) He means that her ideas are unrealistic / He means that her ideas are foolish dreams [1 mark]
(g) He is sceptical / He is doubtful / He is discouraging. [1 mark]
(h) Dialogue / Stage direction / Characterisation. [1 mark]
(i) Metaphor [½ mark]
(j) (i) The sky / The daytime sky / The bright sky. [½ mark]
(ii) Day and night / Light and darkness / The changing sky. [½ mark]
(iii) God's creativity / The beauty of nature / The power of God. [1 mark]

TOTAL = 10 MARKS

PAPER ONE (40 MARKS)

1. C	11. C	21. B	31. D
2. B	12. A	22. C	32. A
3. B	13. B	23. D	33. C
4. A	14. B	24. B	34. A
5. C	15. D	25. C	35. A
6. D	16. B	26. B	36. D
7. D	17. A	27. B	37. A
8. A	18. D	28. A	38. B
9. C	19. C	29. A	39. C
10. D	20. B	30. B	40. C

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